GUIDED CHILDHOOD · PRINT AT HOME · AGES 4 TO 11

The Christmas Screen Free Countdown

24 days of something to do together, away from a screen.



24 door poster | **24 activity cards** | **24 stickers** | **1 to 24 December**

One door a day. Ten to twenty minutes, mostly with things already in your house. Pebble, Bloop, Orbit, Nova and Cosmo take turns, and DiGi sits on top of the tree.

FOR THE GROWN UP · READ THIS ONE FIRST

How the countdown works

Twenty four doors, one a day from 1 December. Behind each door is one small thing to do together away from a screen. Most take ten to twenty minutes and use what is already in the house. There is nothing to buy.

1 · PIN UP THE POSTER

At your child's eye height: the fridge, a door, the bottom of the stairs. Write your family name on it.

2 · CUT OUT THE CARDS

Keep them in an envelope or a mug by the poster. Glance at the planner on page 3 each Sunday so nothing catches you out.

3 · OPEN A DOOR A DAY

Your child finds today's number on the tree. Read the card out and do it together. Ten to twenty minutes is plenty.

4 · STICK THE STICKER

The matching sticker covers the door. Watching the tree fill up is half the fun.

SWAP ANY DAY THAT DOES NOT FIT

Late home, someone poorly, a party? Swap the card with a later one, do two tomorrow, or skip it. A missed door just gets its sticker late.

WHAT IT IS FOR

December evenings are long and everyone is tired, so screens fill a lot of the gaps. Nothing here gets switched off. The countdown adds one small thing a day that you do together, so there is always something else to reach for.

AGES 4 TO 11

Little ones need you for the reading and the scissors. Older ones can run the day themselves, and some will want to. More than one child? Take turns finding the door and sticking the sticker.



The five Planet Friends take a day each, in turn, and DiGi the golden star sits on top of the tree. Ask your child whose day it is before you read the card.

You will need: a printer, scissors, and sticker paper or a glue stick. In the Guided Childhood app, a child's five a day works the same way: a small mix of things to do each day, ticked off together. This countdown is that idea, wrapped up for December.

FOR THE GROWN UP · KEEP IT BY THE POSTER

The 24 days at a glance

Look a week ahead so biscuit day and jigsaw day do not catch you short. Move any day to one that suits you better.

DATE	WHOSE DAY	WHAT WE DO	YOU NEED	DONE
1 Dec	Pebble	**Make a paper chain**	Paper, scissors, glue or tape	○
2 Dec	Bloop	**Hot chocolate and a story**	A book, a mug each	○
3 Dec	Orbit	**Paper snowflakes**	Paper, scissors	○
4 Dec	Nova	**Kitchen disco**	Some music	○
5 Dec	Cosmo	**A card for someone on their own**	Paper, pens	○
6 Dec	Pebble	**Winter lights walk**	Coats, a torch	○
7 Dec	Bloop	**Build a blanket den**	Blankets, chairs, pegs	○
8 Dec	Orbit	**Start a gratitude jar**	A jar, scraps of paper	○
9 Dec	Nova	**Board game night**	Any game, or a pack of cards	○
10 Dec	Cosmo	**Say thank you**	Paper, pens	○
11 Dec	Pebble	**Biscuit day**	Biscuits, or flour, butter and sugar	○
12 Dec	Bloop	**Sock snowball fight**	Clean socks	○
13 Dec	Orbit	**Torch stories**	A torch	○
14 Dec	Nova	**Jigsaw time**	A jigsaw	○
15 Dec	Cosmo	**Cook dinner together**	Tonight's dinner	○
16 Dec	Pebble	**Winter nature table**	A walk, a tray	○
17 Dec	Bloop	**Draw your family**	Paper, pens	○
18 Dec	Orbit	**Sing to someone**	Your voices	○
19 Dec	Nova	**Wrap a present**	Paper, tape	○
20 Dec	Cosmo	**A letter to next year**	Paper, an envelope	○
21 Dec	Pebble	**The shortest day**	Fairy lights or a torch	○
22 Dec	Bloop	**Christmas charades**	Nothing at all	○
23 Dec	Orbit	**Give one thing**	A bag	○
24 Dec	Nova	**Christmas Eve box**	A box, pyjamas, a book	○

QUICK SWAPS FOR A DAY THAT WILL NOT FIT

A bath with extra bubbles and a story. A hunt for ten red things round the house. Build something from the recycling. Breakfast in pyjamas, all at the table. A call to a grandparent.

PRINT AND PIN IT UP

Our Christmas Countdown

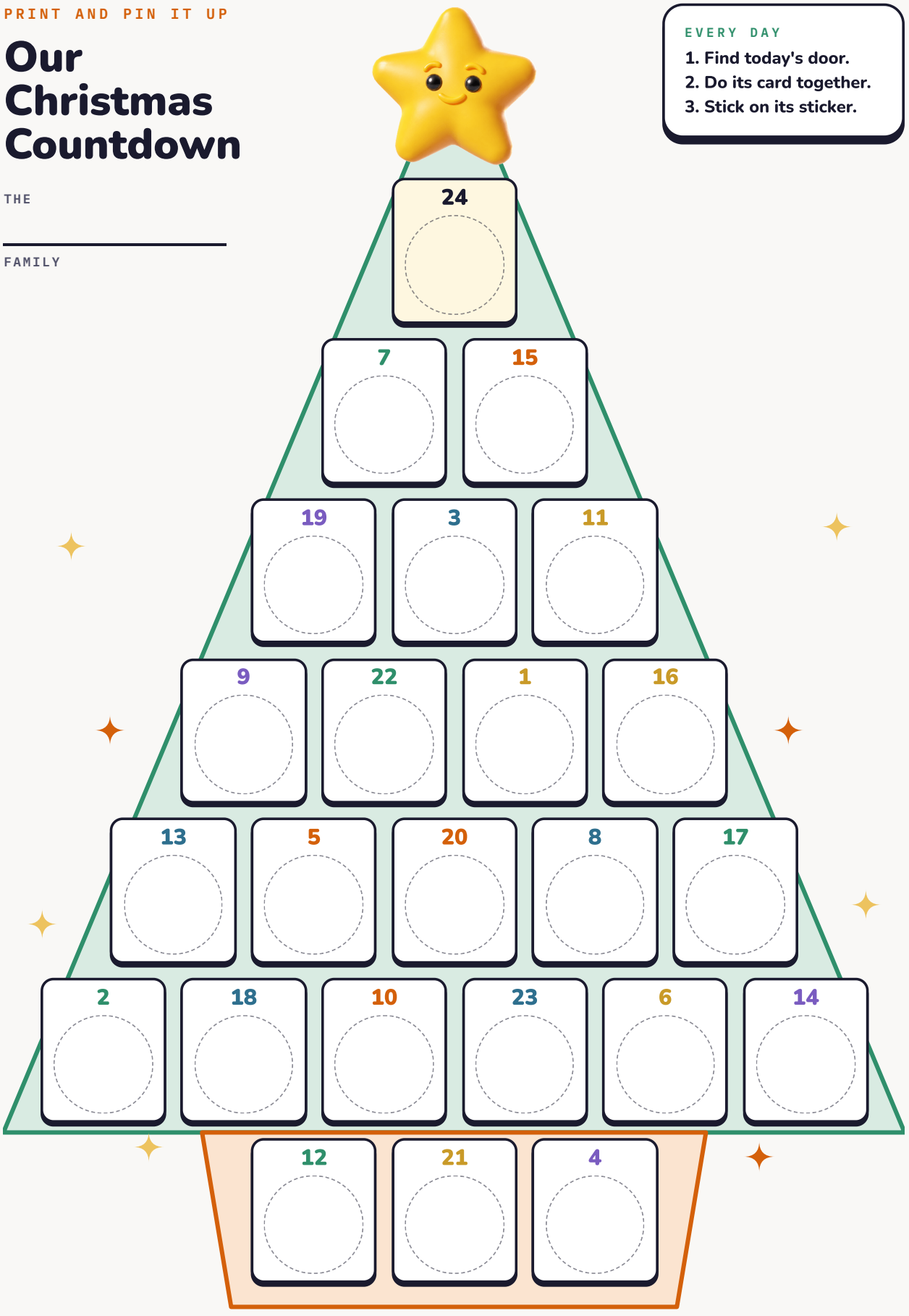
THE

_____

FAMILY

EVERY DAY

1. Find today's door.
2. Do its card together.
3. Stick on its sticker.



CUT OUT · KEEP THEM IN AN ENVELOPE BY THE POSTER

Days 1 to 6

1 DECEMBER
Pebble's day



Make a paper chain

Cut paper into strips, loop them and glue or tape each one into the next. How long can your family make it?

YOU NEED Paper, scissors, glue or tape

2 DECEMBER
Bloop's day



Hot chocolate and a story

Make a warm drink, get under one blanket and read a story out loud. Take turns doing the voices.

YOU NEED A book, a mug each

3 DECEMBER
Orbit's day



Paper snowflakes

Fold a square of paper into a small triangle, snip shapes out of the edges, then open it up. Stick them on a window.

YOU NEED Paper, scissors

4 DECEMBER
Nova's day



Kitchen disco

Everyone picks two songs. Push back the chairs and dance. The grown ups have to dance too.

YOU NEED Some music

5 DECEMBER
Cosmo's day



A card for someone on their own

Make a card for a neighbour or a relative who lives by themselves. Post it, or pop it through their door together.

YOU NEED Paper, pens

6 DECEMBER
Pebble's day



Winter lights walk

Wrap up after dark and walk round your streets. Count the lit up trees and windows. Who spots the most?

YOU NEED Coats, a torch

CUT OUT · KEEP THEM IN AN ENVELOPE BY THE POSTER

Days 7 to 12

7 DECEMBER
Bloop's day



Build a blanket den

Chairs, blankets, cushions and pegs. When it is built, read, play or have a snack inside it.

YOU NEED Blankets, chairs, pegs

8 DECEMBER
Orbit's day



Start a gratitude jar

Write or draw one thing you are glad about on a scrap of paper and drop it in a jar. Add one more each day until Christmas.

YOU NEED A jar, scraps of paper

9 DECEMBER
Nova's day



Board game night

Pick a board game or a pack of cards and play together. The winner chooses the next game.

YOU NEED Any game, or a pack of cards

10 DECEMBER
Cosmo's day



Say thank you

Write a thank you note for a teacher, a lollipop person or the bin crew. Say one thing they do that helps.

YOU NEED Paper, pens

11 DECEMBER
Pebble's day



Biscuit day

Bake a batch together, or ice some plain biscuits from the cupboard. Save one for someone else.

YOU NEED Biscuits, or flour, butter and sugar

12 DECEMBER
Bloop's day



Sock snowball fight

Roll clean socks into balls and have a snowball fight indoors. Then pair all the socks back up.

YOU NEED Clean socks

CUT OUT · KEEP THEM IN AN ENVELOPE BY THE POSTER

Days 13 to 18

13 DECEMBER
Orbit's day



Torch stories

Lights off, torch on. Tell a story one sentence each, then make shadow animals on the wall.

YOU NEED A torch

14 DECEMBER
Nova's day



Jigsaw time

Tip out a jigsaw and do it together, edges first. Leave it out and come back to it later.

YOU NEED A jigsaw

15 DECEMBER
Cosmo's day



Cook dinner together

Everyone gets a job: wash, stir, lay the table or write the menu. The cook is in charge tonight.

YOU NEED Tonight's dinner

16 DECEMBER
Pebble's day



Winter nature table

Go out and collect pine cones, leaves, twigs and stones. Arrange them on a tray at home.

YOU NEED A walk, a tray

17 DECEMBER
Bloop's day



Draw your family

Everyone draws everyone else. Swap the drawings and guess who is who. Pin the best ones up.

YOU NEED Paper, pens

18 DECEMBER
Orbit's day



Sing to someone

Learn one carol or winter song together. Sing it to a neighbour, a grandparent on the phone, or the cat.

YOU NEED Your voices

CUT OUT · KEEP THEM IN AN ENVELOPE BY THE POSTER

Days 19 to 24

19 · 19 DECEMBER · Nova's day



Wrap a present

Wrap something for someone in your family: a drawing, something you made, or a voucher for one free hug.

YOU NEED Paper, tape

20 · 20 DECEMBER · Cosmo's day



A letter to next year

Write or draw a letter to yourself, to open next Christmas. What do you hope the new year brings?

YOU NEED Paper, an envelope

21 · 21 DECEMBER · Pebble's day



The shortest day

Today is the shortest day of the year, or very close. Eat tea by fairy lights or torchlight and each say one thing you are looking forward to.

YOU NEED Fairy lights or a torch

22 · 22 DECEMBER · Bloop's day



Christmas charades

Act out a film, a book, an animal or a Christmas song without saying a word. Everyone guesses.

YOU NEED Nothing at all

23 · 23 DECEMBER · Orbit's day



Give one thing

Choose a toy or a book you have finished with, for a charity shop or a younger friend. Wrap it up if you like.

YOU NEED A bag

24 · 24 DECEMBER · Nova's day



Christmas Eve box

Fill a box with pyjamas, a book and a torch for tonight. Then fill in Our favourite days together.

YOU NEED A box, pyjamas, a book

PRINT ON STICKER PAPER, OR PLAIN PAPER AND A GLUE STICK

Your countdown stickers

One sticker for each door. Cut round the dashed circle and stick it on the door with the same number. Little hands can cut roughly. Nobody checks the edges.



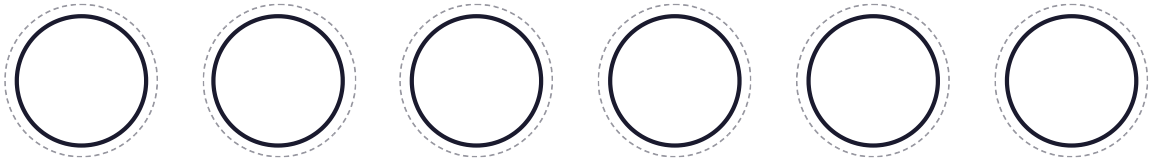
SIX SPARES, WITH DIGI JUNIOR

For a sticker that goes missing, a swapped day, or a day so good it deserves two.



DRAW YOUR OWN

Swapped in an idea of your own? Draw its sticker here: a snowman, a jigsaw piece, your dog in a hat.



Printing tip: choose actual size, not fit to page, so each sticker matches its circle on the poster. More than one child? Print a sheet each and take turns on the doors.

FILL THIS IN TOGETHER ON CHRISTMAS EVE

Our favourite days

OUR THREE BEST DAYS

DAY

It was the best because

DAY

It was the best because

DAY

It was the best because

DRAW THE MOMENT YOU LIKED MOST

IN JANUARY, WE WILL KEEP DOING

Pick one and give it a day of the week. Saturday den night counts.



SIGNED BY ALL OF US

THE GUIDED CHILDHOOD PASSPORT

Your Passport stickers

The Christmas Screen Free Countdown belongs on the Pebble page (ages 4 to 7) or the Bloop page (ages 8 to 10), under the doing, in the Guided Childhood Passport. When your family has used the countdown, cut out the sticker and stick it on that page. The big one fits the stage page and the small one fits the fold out passport.













PRINT THIS PAGE ON STICKER PAPER, OR ON PLAIN PAPER WITH A GLUE STICK

No Passport yet? Look for the Guided Childhood Passport in the same Etsy shop: five stage pages for ages 4 to 16, each one stamped when the talk, the doing and the check are done.



A FREE GIFT FOR YOUR FAMILY

As a thank you, the full Guided Childhood Starter Pack is yours free: the star chart, the jobs that earn the stars, and a whole booklet of things to do away from a screen. Pop your email in at the address below and it is yours.

guidedchildhood.com/etsy-bonus

Made by Justin at Guided Childhood, a dad who got tired of the screen time fight. If the countdown earns a spot on your fridge this December, a kind review on Etsy helps another family find it.